James Macek

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Citizenship: Canadian

Research Interests: Urban & Real Estate economics, Spatial economics

Employment

Assistant Professor of Business Economics, Alberta School of Business 2025-

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Toronto 2025
Committee: Nathaniel Baum-Snow (supervisor),
William Strange, Kevin Lim, Joseph Steinberg

M.A in Economics, University of Toronto 2019

Bachelor of Business Administration, University of Toronto Scarborough 2018

Publications

Housing Supply and Affordability in Canada (with Nathaniel Baum-Snow and Aled Ab Iorwerth)
Canadian Journal of Economics, 2026

Working Papers

Housing Regulation and Neighborhood Sorting across the United States

Gentrification and Redevelopment in General Equilibrium (with Guangbin Hong)

Works in Progress

Segmented Housing Supply (with Nathaniel Baum-Snow and Sidharth Moktan)

Thinking Outside the Lot: Historical Parcel Boundaries and Housing Supply (with Devin Bissky-Dziadyk and Stephan Heblich)

Awards and Grants

SSHRC Connection Grant ($12,500, with Nathan Schiff and Jay Hyun), University of Alberta Startup Grant ($15,000)	2026
University of Alberta Startup Grant ($15,000)	2025
Bank of Canada Best Student Paper ($2500), Honorable Mention for Best Student Paper, Urban Economics Association European Meeting, Ontario Graduate Scholarship ($5000 × 3), AREUEA Travel Grant ($1300), University of Toronto Travel Grants ($1500)	2024
University of Toronto Doctoral Fellowship ($12,000 × 5)	2019-2024
Yurgen Krumma Award in Economics	2017

Teaching

Instructor 2025-

- BUEC 211: Business Economics, Organizations, and Management (Microeconomic Theory for Business Students)

Teaching Assistant 2017 - 25

- ECO 204: Microeconomics for Commerce
- ECO 231: Economics of Global Trade
- ECO 380: Markets, Competition and Strategy
- ECO 220: Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics

Conference and Seminar Presentations

(including scheduled or by co-author)

Notre Dame Housing Economics Research Conference (South Bend), University of Colorado Boulder, Spring Midwest Macroeconomics (Milwaukee), AREUEA National Conference (Washington, DC), Kelley-Chicago Fed Third Symposium on Real Estate and Urban Policy (Indianapolis), Organizer for the Rocky Mountain Urban and Real Estate Conference (Banff), North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Chicago), York University	2026
University of Saskatchewan, Alberta School of Business, UPenn Wharton Real Estate (canceled), CES North American Meeting (Ann Arbor), European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Berlin), Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (Kansas Fed), AREUEA National Conference (Washington, DC), NBER Summer Institute (Real Estate), North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Montreal), Institute Research Conference (Minneapolis Fed)	2025
Bank of Canada Student Award Finalist Conference (winner), Urban Economics Association Summer School (Geneva), European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Copenhagen), University of British Columbia Sauder CUERE Symposium, Annual Conference of the Canadian Economics Association (Toronto), AREUEA Doctoral Poster Session	2024

Refereeing Experience

Journal of Urban Economics (x5), American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Public Choice

Academic Service

Co-Organizer of the Rocky Mountain Urban and Real Estate Conference 2026-
(with Jay Hyun and Nathan Schiff)
Co-Organizer of the Graduate Student Workshop 2023 - 2024

Languages

English (native)
Programming: R, Stata, Python, SQL, MATLAB, GIS (using R, Python and QGIS)

Last Updated: October 21, 2026